

SCHOOLS OF BUDDHISM

COMMON BUDDHIST FOUNDATION → PRACTICAL AND DOCTRINAL MIDDLE → TWELVE-LINKED DEPENDENT ORIGATION → MOMENTARINESS AND NO-SELF → ACTION AND MORAL CONSEQUENCE → ABHIDHARMA SCHOOL FORK

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g14 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 COMMON BUDDHIST FOUNDATION

COMMON BUDDHIST FOUNDATION COMMON THERAPEUTIC CORE SUFFERING (DUHKHA) ORIGIN (TRŚNĀ/AVIDYĀ) CESSATION (NIRVĀṆA) EIGHTFOLD PATH THREE MARKS SUFFERING (DUHKHA) ANĀTMAN DEPENDENT ORIGATION SUPPLIES THE MIDDLE PATH (MADHYAMĀ PRATIPAD) NEITHER ETERNAL SUBSTANCE NOR CAUSELESS ANNIHILATION LATER SCHOOLS DISAGREE

COMMON THERAPEUTIC CORE suffering (duhkha) → origin (trśnā/avidyā) → cessation (nirvāna) → eightfold path three

suffering (duhkha)

anātman dependent origination supplies the Middle Path (madhyamā pratipad)

neither eternal substance nor causeless annihilation later schools disagree about what exists and

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- COMMON THERAPEUTIC CORE suffering (duhkha) → origin (trśnā/avidyā) → cessation (nirvāna) → eightfold path three marks: anitya
- suffering (duhkha)

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- anātman dependent origination supplies the Middle Path (madhyamā pratipad)
- neither eternal substance nor causeless annihilation later schools disagree about what exists and

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- how it is known, not about the need to end ignorance and craving.
- COMMON THERAPEUTIC CORE suffering (duhkha) → origin (trśnā/avidyā) → cessation (nirvāna) → eightfold path three marks: anitya

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: neither eternal substance nor causeless annihilation later schools disagree about what exists and how it is known, not about the need to end ignorance and craving.

01

STAGE 01 PRACTICAL AND DOCTRINAL MIDDLE PATH

PRACTICAL AND DOCTRINAL MIDDLE PATH MIDDLE PATH (MADHYAMĀ PRATIPAD; PALI) MAJJHĪMĀ PAṬIPADĀ PRACTICAL EXTREMES SENSUAL INDULGENCE X SELF-MORTIFICATION POSITIVE ROUTE NOBLE EIGHTFOLD PATH (ĀRYAŚTĀNGAMĀRGA) WISDOM + ETHICAL DISCIPLINE + ETERNALISM X ANNIHILATIONISM DEPENDENT ORIGATION PRESERVES CONDITIONED CONTINUITY WITHOUT FOUR NOBLE TRUTHS

MIDDLE PATH (MADHYAMĀ PRATIPAD)

PALI: MAJJHĪMĀ PAṬIPADĀ practical extremes: sensual indulgence X self-mortification positive route → Noble Eightfold Path

Four Noble Truths → cause → cessation → path → liberation

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- MIDDLE PATH (MADHYAMĀ PRATIPAD)
- PALI: MAJJHĪMĀ PAṬIPADĀ practical extremes: sensual indulgence X self-mortification positive route → Noble Eightfold Path (āryaśtāngamārga) wisdom +

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- Four Noble Truths → cause → cessation → path → liberation
- MIDDLE PATH (MADHYAMĀ PRATIPAD)

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- PALI: MAJJHĪMĀ PAṬIPADĀ practical extremes: sensual indulgence X self-mortification positive route → Noble Eightfold Path (āryaśtāngamārga) wisdom +
- Four Noble Truths → cause → cessation → path → liberation

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Four Noble Truths → cause → cessation → path → liberation.

02

STAGE 02 TWELVE-LINKED DEPENDENT ORIGATION

TWELVE-LINKED DEPENDENT ORIGATION IGNORANCE (AVIDYĀ) IGNORANCE CONDITIONS FORMATIONS; CRAVING AND GRASPING RENEW BECOMING WHEN THIS IS, THAT COMES TO BE, WITH CESSATION END IGNORANCE (AVIDYĀ)/TRŚNĀ BREAK APPROPRIATION END REBIRTH-DUHKHA.

Ignorance (avidyā) → saṃskāra → vijñāna → nāma-rūpa → ṣaḍāyatana → sparśa

vedanā → trśnā → upādāna → bhava → jāti → jarā-maraṇa

IGNORANCE conditions formations; craving and grasping renew becoming

"When this is, that comes to be"

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- Ignorance (avidyā) → saṃskāra → vijñāna → nāma-rūpa → ṣaḍāyatana → sparśa
- vedanā → trśnā → upādāna → bhava → jāti → jarā-maraṇa

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- IGNORANCE conditions formations; craving and grasping renew becoming
- "When this is, that comes to be"

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- with cessation of this, that ceases" reverse order: end ignorance (avidyā)/trśnā → break appropriation → end rebirth-duhkha.
- Ignorance (avidyā) → saṃskāra → vijñāna → nāma-rūpa → ṣaḍāyatana → sparśa

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: "When this is, that comes to be; with cessation of this, that ceases" reverse order: end ignorance (avidyā)/trśnā → break appropriation → end rebirth-duhkha.

03

STAGE 03 MOMENTARINESS AND NO-SELF

MOMENTARINESS AND NO-SELF DEPENDENT ORIGATION (PRATĪTYASAMUTPĀDA) CONDITIONED THINGS ARISE AND PERISH (KṢANIKAVĀDA) CAUSAL EFFICACY BELONGS TO THE MOMENT; NO UNCHANGED VIJÑĀNA NONE IS PERMANENT, INDEPENDENT OR "MINE" NO PERMANENT SELF (NAIRĀTMYAVĀDA) CONTINUITY PERSON ANALYSIS FIVE AGGREGATES (SKANDHAS) RŪPA

DEPENDENT ORIGATION (pratityasamutpada) → conditioned things arise and perish → MOMENTARINESS

(kṣanikavāda) causal efficacy belongs to the moment; no unchanged bearer is required

PERSON ANALYSIS → five aggregates (skandhas) rūpa

vijñāna none is permanent, independent or "mine" → NO PERMANENT SELF (nairātmayavāda) continuity = causal

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- DEPENDENT ORIGATION (pratityasamutpada) → conditioned things arise and perish → MOMENTARINESS
- (kṣanikavāda) causal efficacy belongs to the moment; no unchanged bearer is required

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- PERSON ANALYSIS → five aggregates (skandhas) rūpa
- vijñāna none is permanent, independent or "mine" → NO PERMANENT SELF (nairātmayavāda) continuity = causal series, like flame-to-flame

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- Identity is neither strict sameness nor total unrelatedness.
- DEPENDENT ORIGATION (pratityasamutpada) → conditioned things arise and perish → MOMENTARINESS

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PERSON ANALYSIS → five aggregates (skandhas) rūpa | vedanā | saṃjñā | saṃskāra | vijñāna none is permanent, independent or "mine" → NO PERMANENT SELF (nairātmayavāda) continuity = causal series, like flame-to-flame; Identity is neither strict sameness nor total unrelatedness.

04

STAGE 04 ACTION AND MORAL CONSEQUENCE (KARMA), MEMORY AND CESSATION OF CONDITIONED SUFFERING (NIRVĀṆA)

ACTION AND MORAL CONSEQUENCE (KARMA), MEMORY AND CESSATION OF NO ENDURING SELF (ĀTMAN), YET CAUSAL RESPONSIBILITY INTENTION AT CONDITIONS STREAM FRUIT AT T2 MEMORY LATER COGNITION CAUSALLY CONDITIONED BY EARLIER EXPERIENCE REBIRTH ONE PSYCHO-PHYSICAL SERIES CONDITIONS ANOTHER, WITHOUT SOUL-TRANSMIGRATION OBJECTION IF AGENT PERISHES, ANOTHER RECEIVES RESULT REPLY SUCCESSOR IS NEITHER IDENTICAL NOR WHOLLY DIFFERENT; CAUSAL APPROPRIATION

NO ENDURING SELF (ātman), YET CAUSAL RESPONSIBILITY intention at t1 → conditions stream → fruit

causal appropriation connects cessation of conditioned suffering (nirvāna) = cessation of greed, hatred and delusion

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- NO ENDURING SELF (ātman), YET CAUSAL RESPONSIBILITY intention at t1 → conditions stream → fruit at t2 memory
- causal appropriation connects cessation of conditioned suffering (nirvāna) = cessation of greed, hatred and delusion, not destruction of

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- NO ENDURING SELF (ātman), YET CAUSAL RESPONSIBILITY intention at t1 → conditions stream → fruit at t2 memory
- causal appropriation connects cessation of conditioned suffering (nirvāna) = cessation of greed, hatred and delusion, not destruction of

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- NO ENDURING SELF (ātman), YET CAUSAL RESPONSIBILITY intention at t1 → conditions stream → fruit at t2 memory
- causal appropriation connects cessation of conditioned suffering (nirvāna) = cessation of greed, hatred and delusion, not destruction of

MECHANISM / VERDICT — NO ENDURING SELF (ātman), YET CAUSAL RESPONSIBILITY intention at t1 → conditions stream → fruit at t2 memory = later cognition causally conditioned by earlier experience rebirth = one psycho-physical series conditions another, without soul-transmigration objection: if agent perishes, another receives result reply; successor is neither identical nor wholly different; causal appropriation connects cessation of conditioned suffering (nirvāna) = cessation of greed, hatred and delusion, not destruction of a substance-self.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: if agent perishes, another receives result reply; successor is neither identical nor wholly different; causal appropriation connects cessation of conditioned suffering (nirvāna) = cessation of greed, hatred and delusion, not destruction of a substance-self.

05

STAGE 05 ABHIDHARMA SCHOOL FORK

ABHIDHARMA SCHOOL FORK BUDDHIST REALITY KNOWLEDGE DEBATE HINAYĀNA REALISTS MAHĀYĀNA VAIBHĀṢIKA SAUTRĀNTIKA YOGĀCĀRA MĀDHYAMIKA EXTERNAL EXTERNAL OBJECTS COGNITION EMPTINESS SCHOOL LABELS MARK EPISTEMIC/ONTOLOGICAL POSITIONS, NOT FOUR PATHS TO

BUDDHIST REALITY / KNOWLEDGE DEBATE

HINAYĀNA REALISTS MAHĀYĀNA

Vaibhāṣika Sautrāntika Yogācāra Mādhyanika external external objects cognition emptiness of dharmas inferred

from ideas only all intrinsic nature (svabhāva) directly and causal effects perceived

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- BUDDHIST REALITY / KNOWLEDGE DEBATE
- HINAYĀNA REALISTS MAHĀYĀNA

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- Vaibhāṣika Sautrāntika Yogācāra Mādhyanika external external objects cognition emptiness of dharmas inferred
- from ideas only all intrinsic nature (svabhāva) directly and causal effects perceived

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- SCHOOL LABELS MARK EPISTEMIC/ONTOLOGICAL POSITIONS, NOT FOUR PATHS TO MIX.
- BUDDHIST REALITY / KNOWLEDGE DEBATE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SCHOOL LABELS MARK EPISTEMIC/ONTOLOGICAL POSITIONS, NOT FOUR PATHS TO MIX.

06

STAGE 06 VAIBHĀṢIKA AND SAUTRĀNTIKA

VAIBHĀṢIKA AND SAUTRĀNTIKA ISSUE VAIBHĀṢIKA SAUTRĀNTIKA EXTERNAL OBJECT REAL DHARMAS REAL MOMENTARY DHARMAS EXIST ONLY PRESENT CAUSAL MOMENT STRESSED COGNITION GRASPS SAUTRĀNTIKA ARGUMENT OBJECT-MOMENT IS GONE WHEN AWARENESS OCCURS THEREFORE COGNITION PRESENTS AN IMAGE, FROM WHICH EXTERNAL CAUSE REPRESENTATIVE REALISM MUST EXPLAIN CORRESPONDENCE

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
ISSUE VAIBHĀṢIKA SAUTRĀNTIKA external object real dharmas real momentary causes access direct perception inferred from mental	SAUTRĀNTIKA ARGUMENT: object-moment is gone when awareness occurs	PRESSURE: representative realism must explain correspondence.
image past/future sarvāstivāda: dharmas exist only present causal moment stressed cognition grasps object represents object	therefore cognition presents an image, from which external cause is inferred.	ISSUE VAIBHĀṢIKA SAUTRĀNTIKA external object real dharmas real momentary causes access direct perception inferred from mental
SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
- ISSUE VAIBHĀṢIKA SAUTRĀNTIKA external object real dharmas real momentary causes access direct perception inferred from mental - image past/future sarvāstivāda: dharmas exist only present causal moment stressed cognition grasps object represents object	- SAUTRĀNTIKA ARGUMENT: object-moment is gone when awareness occurs - therefore cognition presents an image, from which external cause is inferred.	- PRESSURE: representative realism must explain correspondence. - ISSUE VAIBHĀṢIKA SAUTRĀNTIKA external object real dharmas real momentary causes access direct perception inferred from mental

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: therefore cognition presents an image, from which external cause is inferred.

07

STAGE 07 YOGĀCĀRA AND MĀDHYAMIKA

YOGĀCĀRA AND MĀDHYAMIKA CONSCIOUSNESS-ONLY DOCTRINE (VJÑĀNAVĀDA) MĀDHYAMIKA EMPTINESS (ŚŪNYATĀ) SUBJECT-OBJECT DUALITY IS CONSTRUCTED ALL THINGS LACK REPRESENTATION-ONLY DEPENDENT ARISING EMPTINESS STORE-CONSCIOUSNESS (ĀLAYA-VIJÑĀNA) STORES BĪJA TENDENCIES TWO TRUTHS PARAMĀRTHA THREE NATURES PARIKALPITĀ, TETRALEMMA REJECTS IS IS-NOT PARATANTRA, PARINISPAṆNA BOTH

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- YOGĀCĀRA / CONSCIOUSNESS-ONLY DOCTRINE (vijñānavāda) MĀDHYAMIKA / EMPTINESS (śūnyatā) subject-object duality is constructed all things lack intrinsic
- nature (svabhāva) vijñapti-mātra: representation-only dependent arising = emptiness store-consciousness (ālaya-vijñāna) stores bīja tendencies two truths: saṃvṛti /

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- paramārtha three natures: parikalpita, tetralemma rejects is / is-not paratantra, parinispanna both / neither as ultimate capture
- CONVERGENCE: dissolve reification

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- DIFFERENCE: Yogācāra privileges purified cognition, while Mādhyanika empties even consciousness and emptiness itself.
- YOGĀCĀRA / CONSCIOUSNESS-ONLY DOCTRINE (vijñānavāda) MĀDHYAMIKA / EMPTINESS (śūnyatā) subject-object duality is constructed all things lack intrinsic

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONVERGENCE: dissolve reification; DIFFERENCE: Yogācāra privileges purified cognition, while Mādhyanika empties even consciousness and emptiness itself.

08

STAGE 08 CRITIQUE AND PYQ ANSWER SPINE

CRITIQUE AND PYQ ANSWER SPINE FLUX CANNOT EXPLAIN CONTINUITY ANĀTMAN WEAKENS AGENCY EMPTINESS (ŚŪNYATĀ) IS NIHILISM CAUSAL SERIES DEPENDENT RESPONSIBILITY EMPTINESS DENIES SELF-NATURE, NOT FUNCTION ANSWER RAIL COMMON CORE

OBJECTIONS: flux cannot explain continuity

anātman weakens agency

emptiness (śūnyatā) is nihilism

REPLIES: causal series

dependent responsibility

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

- OBJECTIONS: flux cannot explain continuity
- anātman weakens agency
- emptiness (śūnyatā) is nihilism
- REPLIES: causal series

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

- dependent responsibility
- emptiness denies self-nature, not function
- ANSWER RAIL common core → twelve links → momentariness → five-skandha no-self
- action and moral consequence (karma)/memory reply → four-school fork → exact school comparison

REPLY / RESIDUAL

- objection/reply → qualified verdict
- CLOSE: Buddhism replaces substance with conditioned process
- its schools progressively debate whether external dharmas, cognition, or any intrinsic nature can be retained.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE: Buddhism replaces substance with conditioned process; its schools progressively debate whether external dharmas, cognition, or any intrinsic nature can be retained.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT LAYER-PLACEMENT NOTE LAYER-PLACEMENT NOTE ALL LAYER 3 MATERIAL FROM THE LEGACY IT SHOULD REFINE A CORE ANSWER, NOT DISPLACE THE LAYER 3 - ADVANCED ADVANCED DERIVATION AND SCHOOL DIVERGENCE IT DIAGNOSES THE STRUCTURE OF CONDITIONED BECOMING HERE AND THIS AVOIDS ETERNALISM BECAUSE NO UNCHANGED SELF GROUNDS THE THE DOCTRINE SUPPORTS DIFFERENT ONTOLOGICAL CONCLUSIONS.

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

- Layer-placement note
- Layer-placement note All Layer 3 material from the legacy complete session is retained here after practice.
- It should refine a core answer, not displace the printed syllabus.
- LAYER 3 - ADVANCED Advanced derivation and school divergence Dependent origination is not a search for the universe's first cause.

ADVANCED OBJECTION

- It diagnoses the structure of conditioned becoming here and now.
- This avoids eternalism because no unchanged self grounds the process, and avoids annihilationism because causal continuity remains.
- The doctrine supports different ontological conclusions.
- Mādhyanika argues that whatever depends on conditions lacks intrinsic nature (svabhāva) and is therefore empty.

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- Vaibhāṣika and Sautrāntika instead emphasise that causally functioning conditioned events are real.
- Their disagreement concerns ultimate status, not whether dependent arising occurs.
- The strongest challenge is regress: if every event is conditioned, what explains the chain as a whole?
- The Buddhist reply is therapeutic and structural rather than foundational—the task is to

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.